

IS THIS SOCIETY ISLAMIC OR COMMERCIAL?

Context: Discussions on current football frenzy and commercialization of religion.

Author: Md. Mukid Hasan Seiam

PREFACE

Religion is a matter of the heart. However, when it transforms into a showy competition, it breeds chaos and hypocrisy within society.

"So woe to those who pray - [but] who are heedless of their prayer - those who make show [of their deeds]"
(Surah Al-Ma'un: 4-6)

This book is a common man's logical and realistic observation against the hypocrisy hidden behind the garb of religion.

CHAPTER 1: CHEAP EMOTIONS

Football is merely a form of entertainment. Yet, even here, some people play the religious card, insisting, "As a Muslim country, we must support such-and-such team."

"And leave those who take their religion as amusement and play and whom the worldly life has deluded."
(Surah Al-An'am: 70)

Invoking religion for a sport whose dress code conflicts with Islamic guidelines is ignorance. Such fatwas only make religion a subject of mockery.

CHAPTER 2: THE CLERICS' RACE

Once, people visited mosques to listen to sermons for spiritual purification. Today, many have entered an unhealthy online race to boost YouTube views.

*"O you who have believed, why do you say what you do not do? Most hateful it is in the sight of Allah that you say what you do not do."
(Surah As-Saff: 2-3)*

Those who once condemned movie stars are now running the race to go viral. The pulpit of sermons has unfortunately become a massive platform for backbiting.

CHAPTER 3: COMMERCIALIZATION

Under the banner of preaching, a glamorous business is thriving. Islamic ghazals are now composed in tune with Bollywood beats and melodies.

"And do not mix the truth with falsehood... and do not exchange My verses for a small price [i.e., worldly gain]."
(Surah Al-Baqarah: 41-42)

This does not elevate spirituality; rather, it turns faith into cheap entertainment. By selling religion, many attempt to assert their moral superiority in society.

CHAPTER 4: 1400 YEARS OF HISTORY

Those who issue grand fatwas boast of defending Islam while utilizing Facebook and YouTube—platforms created by non-Muslims—to spread their message.

"Do you order righteousness of the people and forget yourselves while you recite the Scripture? Then will you not reason?"

(Surah Al-Baqarah: 44)

If we truly wish to practice faith purely, we should first detach from technologies built by others. Doing the opposite—trading views while sitting on their platforms—is extreme hypocrisy.

CONCLUSION

I do not claim to be a perfect believer, but I am a part of this faith. Thus, when I witness business and abuse of power running rampant in the name of religion, it becomes a source of extreme frustration.

*"And do not pursue that of which you have no knowledge. Indeed, the hearing, the sight and the heart - about all those you will be questioned."
(Surah Al-Isra: 36)*

We must cast aside blind emotions and understand religion through the lens of reality. The wise are seekers of truth, not hypocrisy.

THE END